

Spacecraft

Air

Spacecraft are machines that are launched by rocket engines out into space. Many of them are unmanned probes, sent out to explore parts of the solar system. A small number have been manned, and have carried more than 500 people into space. In 1969, an American **Apollo 11 spacecraft** was launched by a Saturn V rocket and carried three astronauts into orbit around the moon. Two of them descended in the Lunar Module onto the moon's surface.

Apollo 11 spacecraft



Engine nozzle

Service Module ›

This module provided life-support systems and power for the crew, and housed the spacecraft's main engine.

Fuel tanks ›

Tanks within the Service Module supplied fuel to the main engine.

Thrusters ›

Small thrusters made fine adjustments to the spacecraft's movements.

Command Module ›

The 10-ft-6-in- (3.2-m-) tall Command Module was the only part of the Apollo spacecraft to return to Earth. It orbited the Moon, while the astronauts completed a return journey to its surface in the Lunar Module, then separated from the Service Module and traveled back to Earth.